INCH-POUND

A-A-20173A
April 4, 1994
SUPERSEDING
A-A-20173
May 25, 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

LETTUCE, FRESH, READY-TO-USE

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers fresh ready-to-use lettuce, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government.

Salient characteristics.

The fresh ready-to-use lettuce shall conform to the type, style, and thickness, as applicable, in the following list which shall be specified, as required, in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Types.

Type I - Iceberg
Type II - Boston
Type III - Bibb
Type IV - Similar types

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Head, Food Quality Assurance Staff, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2506, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.

FSC 8915

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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Styles.

Style 1 - Whole head, cored
Style 2 - Chopped, coarse
Style 3 - Chopped, medium
Style 4 - Shredded

Thicknesses (for shredded style). 1/

Thickness a - 1/16 inch (0.159 cm)
Thickness b - 1/8 inch (0.318 cm)
Thickness c - 3/16 inch (0.476 cm)
Thickness d - 1/4 inch (0.635 cm)

1/ Not more than 10 percent, by count, of shreds shall be 1/16 inch (0.159 cm), as applicable, of the thickness specified.

The lettuce, prior to preparation, shall meet the requirements of U.S. No. 1 grade or better in accordance with the U.S. Standards for Grades of Lettuce. The lettuce used shall be closely trimmed lettuce from which the cores have been removed in accordance with good commercial practice.

Cored whole head lettuce shall consist of cored lettuce with the heads intact.

Coarse chopped lettuce shall consist of 1-inch (2.54 cm) minimum to 3-inches (7.62 cm) maximum cut pieces, unless a size within that range is specified.

Medium chopped lettuce shall consist of 1/4- to 1-inch (0.635 to 2.54 cm) cut pieces, unless a specific size within that range is specified.

Shredded lettuce shall consist of shreds $\pm$ 1/16 to 1/4 inch (0.159 to 0.635 cm) in width. The lettuce shall be uniformly cut (sliced) to yield shreds of the thickness specified.

The ready-to-use lettuce shall be firm, fresh, and crisp and not soft or tough. The fresh ready-to-use lettuce shall not be bitter in flavor.

The prepared lettuce shall be free from defects which materially detract from its appearance or edibility. Presence of any decay, off-odor, off-color, or foreign material (e.g.; metal, glass, wood, paint, or insect parts) shall be cause for rejection.

The fresh ready-to-use lettuce shall not be prepared more than 24 hours prior to the required loading time for delivery.

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The fresh ready-to-use lettuce may be treated with antioxidants which are listed on the Food and Drug Administration's Generally Recognized as Safe list. However, prepared lettuce intended for use in the fresh state shall not be treated with sulfur dioxide or other sulfiting agents as prohibited under provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

The fresh ready-to-use lettuce shall be kept under refrigeration to maintain product condition. Unless otherwise specified, fresh ready-to-use lettuce shall be maintained at a temperature between 33° and 40°F (0.56° and 4.4°C).

Contractor's certification.

By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the fresh ready-to-use lettuce offered meets the specified salient characteristics and requirements of this CID; conforms to the producer's own specifications and standards, including product characteristics, manufacturing procedures, quality control procedures, and storage and handling practices; has a national or regional distribution from storage facilities located within the United States, its territories, or possessions; and is sold on the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to determine proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery from point of origin and any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

The fresh ready-to-use lettuce shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the lettuce within the commercial marketplace. The fresh ready-to-use lettuce shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

Quality assurance.

When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the Fresh Products Branch (FPB), Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture will determine the quality assurance of the fresh ready-to-use lettuce according to FPB procedures. The fresh ready-to-use lettuce shall be examined or analyzed in accordance with applicable provisions in the CID, and when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers currently in effect on the date of the solicitation.

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Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.

The fresh ready-to-use lettuce shall be preserved, packaged, packed, labeled, and case marked in accordance with good commercial practice. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, shall be acceptable. Shipping containers shall comply with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

For Department of Defense procurements.

The following requirements are applicable when specified by the contracting officer.

A. Commercial packaging. Five or ten pounds (2.268 or 4.536 kg) of lettuce shall be packaged in a polyethylene bag in accordance with good commercial practice.

B. Commercial packing. Twenty or forty pounds (9.072 or 18.144 kg) of packaged lettuce shall be packed in fiberboard boxes complying with the Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification.

C. Unit loads. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for Type II, Class F loads.

D. Labeling. Commercial labeling shall be acceptable.

E. Marking. Marking of shipping containers and unit loads shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

Notes.

Sources of documents.

Sources of information for nongovernmental documents are as follows:

Copies of the National Motor Freight Classification may be obtained from:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
2200 Mill Road
Alexandria, VA 22314

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Copies of the Uniform Freight Classification may be obtained from:

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1120
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1-199. This three-volume set may be purchased from:

Superintendent of Documents
U.S. Government Printing Office
Washington, DC 20402-0001

Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents at (202) 783-3238.

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from:

Chairperson
Condition of Container Committee
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Room 2506, South Building
P.O. Box 96456
Washington, DC 20090-6456

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from:

General Services Administration
Specifications Unit (3FB-WS)
Room 6654
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407

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Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Building 4, Section D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - NIH, IHS
USDA - FV

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - FV

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